

MySQL is a scalable database software and is used by high volume websites, projects and in critical business applications. However, as applications and services grow, the main database often undergoes sharding and

multiple database software are used wherever applicable. Nevertheless, it is one of the most, if not the most used database solution out there at the moment.



MariaDB

- Platform: Windows, Linux, and macOS
- Languages: C++, C#, Java, Python, and many others.
- Cloud version available: Yes

When Oracle acquired Sun Microsystems in 2010, Ulf Michael Widenius, the original creator of MySQL forked it to create MariaDB. Naturally,

it practically has all of the features of MySQL and has evolved quite well over the years. MariaDB is also a relational database management system and can easily replace MySQL should the project require it. In fact, it's so similar that you can consider it to be a drop-in replacement for MySQL with minimal modifications required.



Considering how similar MariaDB is to MySQL, a lot of the cloud service providers which provide MySQL as an option, often have exactly the same offerings with MariaDB. From a feature point of view, MariaDB has additional features compared to MySQL and it is also faster than MySQL when it comes to handling large-sized data. MariaDB is often considered to be a better performer than MySQL.

PostgreSQL

- Platform: Windows, Linux, and macOS.
- Languages: PL/pgSQL, PL/Tcl, PL/Perl, and PL/Python.
- Cloud version available: No